ROADIVO · CARPLAY · 21 OCTOBER 2026

Roadivo vs CarTV

Why Roadivo can't show video, a web browser or a full-screen cast on the CarPlay screen the way CarTV does, how CarTV does it, and which other apps do the same.

PART 1

The three CarTV features Roadivo can't add

FEATURE	CARTV	WHY ROADIVO CAN'T	ROADIVO INSTEAD
Video on the car screen	Its own player on the car screen	**Needs a self-drawn car screen (1, 2, 3), and Apple's own CarPlay video isn't open to Roadivo yet (4)**	Sound with Apple's Now Playing. Video while parked when iOS allows it.
Web browser on the car screen	Address bar, search and full web pages	**Needs a self-drawn car screen (1, 2, 3)**	A Browser tab with sites and search; the page opens on the iPhone
Full-screen cast	The whole iPhone screen inside CarPlay	**Needs a self-drawn car screen (1, 2, 3)**	Cast to Screen for car screens with a web browser, and AirPlay Screen Mirroring

PART 2

The reasons

1. **Only navigation apps can draw their own car screen.**
   Other CarPlay apps can only use Apple's ready-made screens: lists, tabs, search and Now Playing. None of them can show a video player, a web page or a mirrored iPhone. Even navigation apps may only draw a map there.
   Apple: "This method is provided only for navigation apps; other apps should use the variant that does not provide a window."

2. **Roadivo isn't a navigation app.**
   To get that permission, Roadivo would have to tell Apple it gives directions. Apple can then remove the app and close the developer account, with every app on it. A small added map doesn't change this.

3. **It isn't safe while driving.**
   CarPlay allows video only when parked, and Apple's screens enforce that. A self-drawn screen skips it. CarTV only asks the user "are you parked?", so the car can't stop video or a browser on the move.

4. **Apple's own CarPlay video isn't open to Roadivo yet.**
   Apple doesn't allow the CarPlay Audio and Video approvals in one app; with both, iOS showed a blank car screen. With Audio only, iOS 27.0.1 tells Roadivo the car can't play video. Apple's guide for iOS 27.2 lets Audio apps show video while parked, and Roadivo is ready for it.

Would supporting iOS 18 help? No. Roadivo already runs on iOS 17 and later. The navigation-only rule applies on every iOS version, and iOS 18 has no CarPlay video at all.

PART 3

How did CarTV get navigation approval?

- **CarTV has no visible navigation features.** Its App Store listing and website describe a playlist player, media servers, Car Mode, screen mirroring and casting. There are no maps, routes or directions, and it's listed under Utilities, not Navigation.
- **Apple grants CarPlay approvals privately.** A developer describes the app on Apple's CarPlay request form, and Apple approves that app. We can't see what CarTV wrote, or whether Apple knows how CarTV uses the approval.
- **App Review checks the build separately.** CarTV's car screens only appear with CarPlay connected, so an approval granted for one purpose can be used for another without Apple noticing straight away.
- **That may be changing.** CarTV's own website warns that the iOS 27.2 beta "may prevent some features from working properly", and tells users not to update. It doesn't say why.

In short: CarTV's visible features don't qualify it as a navigation app under Apple's rules. How it got navigation approval isn't public.

PART 4

Other apps like CarTV

APP	WHAT IT SAYS IT DOES ON THE CAR SCREEN	HOW
CarCast: Cast M3U TV Player Aman Singhal ·out 14 Oct 2026 ·2 ratings	"View your playlists and media on the car display", with channel switching and screen mirroring	`Same as CarTV` Its own car screen. Not allowed for Roadivo (Part 2).
AutoCinema: Car IPTV Player ismail budak ·out 6 Oct 2026 ·0 ratings	"Video while you're parked, sound while you drive"; video on the car screen "needs iOS 26.4 or later". Also claims screen mirroring, without saying how.	`Apple's CarPlay video` The car decides when video plays. Roadivo can do this.
Car TV: Smart M3U IPTV Player ALLEY 51 ·out 16 Oct 2026 ·2 ratings	"CarPlay video playback requires … a vehicle or head unit that supports video playback"; video only while parked	`Apple's CarPlay video` The car decides when video plays. Roadivo can do this.

What this shows: all three appeared in October 2026. Only CarCast copies CarTV's own car screen, and being on the App Store doesn't mean Apple approved how it uses CarPlay. The other two describe Apple's own CarPlay video, which plays only while parked. That's the route Roadivo is set up for (Part 2, reason 4).

Sources: CarTV on the App Store (id6800211040) and cartv.app; the App Store listings of CarCast (id6816670712), AutoCinema (id6818349626) and Car TV (id6818414002), read on 21 October 2026; Apple Developer Forums 851377 and 843374; Apple's CarPlay Developer Guide and the CarPlay framework (iOS 27.1 SDK); tests in Xcode's CarPlay Simulator on an iPhone 11 Pro, iOS 27.0.1. How CarTV works is inferred from these.